

DIRECTOR OR VP OF ENGINEERING.

A NOTE FROM MIKE ON THE ENGINEERING LEADER WE'RE HIRING, AND THE PLATFORM WE'RE HANDING THEM.

Birdseye runs the gates on some of the busiest yards in North America. Bison Transport. C.R. England. About four hundred of us, across four operations floors in Mississauga, Dallas, Belgrade, and Bogotá. Twelve million gate events a month.

The platform underneath this is the operating system for the yard. Cameras, sensors, AI on every stream, TMS and WMS integrations, agentic decisioning, an operator console, and an audit trail that holds up in court. It is a real product, and it is at the point where the next chapter has to be designed by someone who has done it before.

I'm writing this myself because I want the right person to read it from me. We are hiring a Director or VP of Engineering to own this platform end-to-end. Not to manage it. To **OWN** it. To come in with a clear point of view of what visionary work looks like in this category, and to push hard against me, against the team, against the inertia of operating at scale, to bring that vision to life.

I want autonomy, control, and intention. Autonomy, because the platform is theirs to set the direction for. Control, because they will own the system and the team that builds it. Intention, because every architectural decision in the next twelve months will compound for a decade.

The career arc I want: developer first, engineering manager second, director or VP third. Technical credibility before management credibility. The hand still needs to know where the code lives.

AI-native, not AI-curious. We use AI inside the product and inside how we build the product. The difference between a leader who has changed how a team writes, reviews, and ships code, and one who has experimented personally with Copilot, is the difference between us hiring and us not hiring.

Built a **PRODUCT, not delivered a project.**

We are not running a delivery shop. The leader I want has lived inside a product business. Recurring revenue. Customers who can leave. A platform that has to keep earning the right to exist every quarter.

AI is a **MULTIPLIER, not a substitute.**

A sloppy team with AI ships sloppier code, faster. A rigorous team with AI does the work of three. Tell us what changed in your team's workflow, what you measured, what you kept. Not slides. Receipts.

The bar is hands-on **CREDIBILITY.**

Not a role for someone who has not opened a pull request in five years. If the senior engineers don't walk out of the first architecture review thinking **FINALLY**, we picked wrong.

IF YOU HAVE BUILT AND OPERATED A REAL PLATFORM, AND YOU WANT THE NEXT DECADE OF YARD INFRASTRUCTURE TO HAVE YOUR FINGERPRINTS ON IT, WE SHOULD TALK.

MIKE GRABOVICA

FOUNDER & CEO · BIRDSEYE

MISSISSAUGA, ONTARIO · MAY 2026

THE ROLE IN DETAIL

01 PLATFORM ARCHITECTURE.

Own the technical direction for the entire stack. Gate automation, site configuration, customer workflows, integrations, the data layer, the operator console, the AI pipeline that pre-processes every stream. Make the decisions the company will still be glad we made in 2030.

02 ENGINEERING EXECUTION.

Build a predictable delivery system. Clear ownership. Real planning. Real risk management. Move us off heroes and onto a process that scales without sacrificing the speed that got us here.

03 TEAM LEADERSHIP.

Manage and upgrade the engineering team. Coach managers and senior engineers. Create accountability without destabilizing the people who have carried the platform this far. Hire the next wave.

04 AN AI-NATIVE DEVELOPMENT SYSTEM.

Make AI-native coding part of the operating model. Not a side experiment. Define the tools, practices, review standards, guardrails. Measure the lift. Push the team somewhere the rest of the industry will catch up to in two years.

05 PRODUCTION RELIABILITY.

Own reliability, observability, incident review, and operational readiness for a platform where the customer's freight depends on us being right. Reliability is a culture. The leader sets it.

06 SCALING THE PLATFORM.

Support a much larger customer base, many more sites, higher event volume, complex integrations, and the hybrid cloud and data-center reality of operating on customer-owned infrastructure. The next 10x is not optional.

07

BUSINESS ALIGNMENT.

Connect engineering decisions to adoption, gross margin, implementation velocity, customer reliability, and long-term product leverage. Engineering is a profit center if it is led like one.

WHAT GREAT LOOKS LIKE

A great candidate walks into a working session in month two and answers these without notes. With a point of view specific to this platform that they will defend.

01

HOW SHOULD OUR PLATFORM SCALE TECHNICALLY OVER THE NEXT TWELVE MONTHS?

02

WHERE ARE THE HIDDEN RISKS IN RELIABILITY, INTEGRATIONS, DATA FLOW, AND TEAM STRUCTURE?

03

HOW DO WE MAKE ENGINEERING MEASURABLY FASTER USING AI-NATIVE CODING?

04

HOW DO WE REDUCE THE PLATFORM'S DEPENDENCY ON INDIVIDUAL HEROES?

05

HOW DO WE MAKE THE TEAM MORE PREDICTABLE WITHOUT MAKING IT SLOWER?

06

HOW DO WE CONNECT ARCHITECTURE TO ADOPTION, MARGIN, AND CUSTOMER SUCCESS?

THE BAR

Each line is a hard requirement with the reason attached. The reason matters as much as the rule.

01

Ten-plus years in software engineering.

The platform has architectural decisions that pre-date most of the team. We need a leader who recognizes the patterns and the smells without needing them explained.

02

Five-plus years in engineering management.

Run managers, not just engineers. Coaching the layer below you is a different muscle than being individually productive.

03 **Developer to Engineering Manager to Director or VP.**

The hand still needs to know where the code lives. We don't hire people whose first technical job was managing technical people.

04 **Built and operated a recurring-revenue product platform.**

B2B SaaS or subscription. A business where the customer can leave. We need the discipline that comes from earning the renewal.

05 **Hands-on cloud-native architecture experience.**

AWS, GCP, or Oracle Cloud (Azure acceptable). We will ask you to whiteboard a real piece of our infrastructure on day one of the loop.

06 **Web-scale client/server, distributed systems, microservices.**

High-availability production. You don't need to be a streaming-video specialist, but you need to have shipped at scale.

07 **AI-native coding, implemented with a team.**

Not a personal Copilot subscription. Tell us what changed in your team's workflow, what you measured, what broke, what you kept.

08 **Operated systems where uptime and reliability mattered.**

We're not asking if your dashboard had four nines. We're asking what happened the night it didn't.

09 **Turned a founder-led or hero-driven team into a scalable organization.**

We are mid-transition. We need a leader who has lived the same transition before and knows its timing.

STRONG PREFERENCES

Not required. A real advantage. The kind of background that earns a longer conversation on day one.

TORONTO / GTA

Strongly preferred. Most of the platform team and most of the leadership is here.

BIG TECH + STARTUP

Big Tech standards, startup velocity. People who have lived both sides of that calibration consistently outperform those who have only lived one.

VIDEO STREAMING

Camera-to-cloud, WebRTC, RTSP, HLS, low-latency delivery, multi-tenant video platforms, edge-to-cloud pipelines, observability at scale.

COMPUTER VISION	Video analytics, object detection, edge or cloud-based CV systems. Especially CV taken from prototype to production with paying customers.
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HYBRID CLOUD / DC	Cloud and on-prem at the same time. Connectivity, networking, latency, secure connectivity. We operate on customer-owned infrastructure.
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ADJACENT DOMAINS	Logistics, IoT, security, infrastructure, workflow automation, multi-site operations.
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WHO THIS ISN'T FOR

Said plainly so nobody spends a month in a loop they were never going to win.

Not for a leader whose primary career has been inside a bank, a government agency, or a large institution where operating tempo is set by an org chart rather than by customers.

Not for a consulting or agency leader whose success has been measured by delivery against a contract rather than the long-term health of a platform.

Not for a pure people manager, no matter how senior. We need a leader who can still go deep technically when the team needs it.

Not for an AI tourist. We will ask, in detail, and we will know the difference.

LOGISTICS

LOCATION	Greater Toronto Area strongly preferred. Hybrid, with regular time in our Mississauga office.
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REPORTS TO	Mike Grabovica, Founder & CEO. Partners closely with the CTO and operations leadership.
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COMPENSATION	Competitive for a Toronto-based senior engineering leader. Cash, meaningful equity, full benefits.
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HIRING PROCESS	Four conversations over two to three weeks. A first call with Mike. A working session with platform leadership on a real architectural problem. A team-fit set. A final conversation with the executive team.
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START DATE	Flexible. Preference for Q3 2026.
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APPLY.

Send your résumé and a short note on the most consequential platform decision you have made in the last five years. Not the most successful. The most consequential.

[WRITE DIRECTLY](mailto:hello@birdseyesecurity.ca) hello@birdseyesecurity.ca

[VIA ATS](https://birdseyeaccount.bamboohr.com/careers) birdseyeaccount.bamboohr.com/careers

[READ ON WEB](https://birdseyesecurity.com/role/vp-engineering) birdseyesecurity.com/role/vp-engineering